

MITCHELL WILLIAMS

INTERNAL STORYTELLING ACROSS FORMATS · EDITORIAL SYSTEMS & VOICE GOVERNANCE · AI-ASSISTED CREATIVE PIPELINES

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Selected work: #FreeAhmed (April 2026: helped free journalist Ahmed Shihab-Eldin in ten days, acquitted on the central charge) · Google engineer profiles · 50M-view measles explainer · Writing room with verbatim published scripts

SUMMARY

Content producer and editorial lead who tells the story of technical work in whatever format lands: video, live events, newsletters, podcasts, artifacts. Finds the story inside an organization's people and culture, picks the format that serves it, owns production end to end, and builds the editorial system that holds the bar when the volume grows.

Eight years at Google translating engineering work into stories people actually engage with: talent-branding video with 1.7M+ YouTube views, executive communications for the CIO, and two production LLM agents that draft high-stakes communications in a principal's own voice under a codified editorial standard.

The newsroom decade is the home turf: founding team of Al Jazeera English's social-first live show, line production on Fusion's primetime flagship, and an explainer line at AJ+ whose proof-of-concept hit 50M+ views.

FIT FOR CONTENT PRODUCER & EDITORIAL LEAD ROLES

- **Finding and building narratives:** Designed the AJ+ day-of explainer line to find the story inside the day's news and ship it same day; the proof-of-concept hit 50M+ views and the format became permanent.
- **Producing across mediums, owned end to end:** Live broadcast, social video, explainer series, newsletters, in-person events (600+ attendee summit, quarterly forums), and an AI video pipeline: script in, produced short out with audio end to end (narration, score, sound design).
- **Editorial standards as systems, not vibes:** A codified voice "Constitution," a banned-phrase checklist, a six-axis voice-quality rubric (voice-os), and a triage / revise / escalate review workflow; quality holds without the editor in every loop.
- **Moving extremely quickly and fluidly:** When Nelson Mandela died, rebuilt the rundown overnight and line-produced Fusion's 44-minute live primetime breaking-news special: ABC News packages, White House audio, four consecutive live phone experts.
- **AI-assisted production:** I built two production LLM agents at Google, plus PictureLock and content-ops on my own time (case studies). The rule I build by: AI does the mechanical work, the editorial cut stays human.

EXPERIENCE

Internal Communications Lead

Google · Cross-Google Engineering (xGE) | June 2024 – Present

Communications lead for the horizontal org that drives technical change across Google, serving 1,000+ Principal, Distinguished, and Fellow engineers; designed the three-tier communications operating model behind the annual summit (600+ attendees), quarterly forums, and the senior-engineering newsletters.

Executive-communications "digital twin" (Gemini agent)

- **Problem:** High-stakes VP communications required long review cycles to hold a consistent voice.
- **Action:** Built and deployed a production Gemini agent loaded with a "Constitution" of voice rules plus a banned-phrase verification checklist.
- **Impact:** Cut review back-and-forth with the VP by about 70% (internal, self-measured).

Communications-triage agent (Apps Script + Gemini)

- **Problem:** Comms-inbox intake consumed operator hours on low-complexity requests.
- **Action:** Built and deployed an autonomous triage agent, documented end to end and handed off with a full operator runbook.
- **Impact:** Designed to auto-handle ~60% of inbound requests without escalation (est.) and projected to recapture ~160 operator hours a year (est.).

xGE Connects, peer-led workshop series

- **Problem:** Senior engineers' expertise was not reaching the tier below repeatably.
- **Action:** Designed and ran the peer-led speaker series plus the annual survey that shapes the community's roadmap.
- **Impact:** Q1-2026 sessions, hosted by Google DeepMind engineers, drew record attendance.

Senior Communications & Content Strategist

Google · Corporate Engineering (TechStop) | April 2018 – June 2024

Owned the communications and content (documentation, self-help, onboarding, video) for Google's internal IT org and its global help desk; a 2023 content audit lifted self-service solvability 9.03%, roughly 10,670 fewer tickets per year.

Engineering talent-branding video portfolio

- **Problem:** Engineering hiring needed stories, not job listings.
- **Action:** Produced recruitment campaigns, interview-prep and hiring videos, and talent-branding content, running field shoots end to end with vendor crews (shooters, director of photography, AV, sound).
- **Impact:** 1.7M+ YouTube views across the portfolio.

Executive communications for the CIO

- **Problem:** Corporate Engineering's technical priorities needed a leadership voice.
- **Action:** Wrote executive communications for then-CIO Ben Fried, translating dense technical priorities into leadership-ready narrative.
- **Impact:** Became a trusted ghostwriting voice for Corporate Engineering leadership.

Self-service onboarding curriculum

- **Problem:** Instructor-led Day-One technical orientation did not scale to Google's hiring volume.
- **Action:** Overhauled it into a self-service curriculum a new hire completes without a facilitator.
- **Impact:** Delivered to 75,000+ new hires at an 88% CSAT score.

EARLIER CAREER: LIVE NATIONAL NEWS (2007 – 2018)

The engine of live news is the engine of internal storytelling: the message lands the first time, under deadline, in the voice of the person whose name carries it.

- **AJ+, Senior Producer (2016 – 2018):** Led 10+ producers on a social-video channel reaching 500M weekly views; designed a day-of explainer line whose proof-of-concept hit 50M+ views and became permanent, and which doubled as a **talent pipeline**.
- **CNN, Writer / Producer, "New Day" (2016):** Wrote and produced morning-show segments through the election cycle; adapted broadcast segments for social redistribution.
- **Fusion (ABC News / Univision), Senior Producer, "America With Jorge Ramos" (2013 – 2015):** Owned daily line-production on the primetime flagship through a 179% viewership-growth window (40M households); field-produced live from Hong Kong's **Umbrella Revolution**.
- **HuffPost Live, Segment Producer (2012 – 2013):** Produced through the award-winning launch era (Mashable "Biggest Innovation in Media," 2012; Webby, 2013).
- **Al Jazeera English "The Stream" · CGTN America (2010 – 2012):** Founding-team Associate Producer on the network's social-first live show; launch night pivoted to the **bin Laden** raid and pioneered social-data journalism; then owned the daily rundown at CGTN America's DC bureau.

PORTFOLIO AND PROJECTS

Portfolio · **The writing room:** the verbatim published AJ+ **measles explainer** script, 17 authored longform story pages, and redacted-verbatim Google work samples.

PictureLock · Seven-stage script-to-short video pipeline (Node + ffmpeg, ElevenLabs stack): narration, score, sound design, generated shots, multilingual dub. The 53-second live demo carries \$8.26 of logged cost in the run manifest committed at github.com/mitwilli-create/picture-lock; the Spanish dub carries a separately logged \$0.42.

content-ops · A multi-agent engine that adapts one story to each of nine platforms' native formats through deterministic voice gates, with a person pressing send (**case study**).

voice-os · Six-axis voice-quality rubric with a codified voice "Constitution" and banned-phrase checklist, calibrated on a multi-million-word corpus; surfaces voice deltas back to the writer.

EDUCATION

BA, Journalism | Indiana University Bloomington

CERTIFICATIONS

AI Fluency · Claude 101 · Agent Skills · Model Context Protocol · Skill Builder (Opus cohort) | Anthropic | 2026

SKILLS

Content, Media & Internal Communications: video and live-broadcast production, script-to-short AI pipelines, social-first format design, on-camera talent coaching, executive-voice drafting and ghostwriting, internal-comms strategy at engineering scale, editorial standards and review workflows; applied AI: agent design (Apps Script + Gemini, Node.js), AI narration and dubbing (ElevenLabs), Claude Code / MCP.

